



Medford Bus Service: Current Frequencies & Proposed BNR Changes

A corridor-by-corridor analysis of existing combined bus service and what changes under the MBTA's Bus Network Redesign (BNR)'s Proposal 2: Improve Medford Access.

Corridors: High St · Boston Ave · George St

Routes: 80, 94, 95, 96 / T96

Comment period: through Summer 2026

mbta.com/projects/bus-network-redesign-proposed-updates

Note: The MBTA is *exploring* three amendment options and has not committed to any of them. The agency may also proceed with the original BNR plan without adopting any amendment. Public feedback collected through summer 2026 will inform the final decision.

About this analysis. Bus service on a given street depends on all routes serving that street — not just one route. This exhibit analyzes the three corridors most directly affected by Proposal 2, showing *combined* current frequency (how often a bus actually arrives, across all routes) alongside proposed BNR frequency and the impact of each amendment option. Current figures are computed from official MBTA timetables effective April 5, 2026. Proposed figures are from the MBTA's BNR Remix planning map. "Combined" headways reflect merged departure times from all routes on a segment.

PART 1 — CORRIDOR ANALYSIS

Combined current frequency · Proposed BNR frequency · Impact of each option

The three corridors below are those directly affected by the amendment options under Proposal 2. Each shows the combined frequency from all routes currently serving that street, alongside what the BNR proposes and how each option would change it. Combined headways are computed by merging actual departure times from all routes on a segment — not by averaging individual route headways. Because buses on different routes do not arrive evenly spaced in practice, combined figures will generally be somewhat higher than a purely theoretical calculation would suggest. Individual route headways are shown separately in Part 3 for reference.

Corridor 1 — High Street between Boston Ave and Medford Square

Current routes: **80** **95** Proposed:

80 **95**

SERVICE PERIOD	CURRENT COMBINED (RTS. 80 + 95)	PROPOSED BNR (RTS. 80 + 95)	CHANGE
Weekday AM peak (5–9 AM)	Weekday midday (9 AM–3 PM)	Weekday PM peak (3–7 PM)	Weekday evening (7 PM–10 PM)
avg 15 min	avg 19 min	avg 20 min	avg 25 min
~14 min 80: 25 min · 95: 20 min	~18 min 80: 50 min · 95: 20 min	~14 min 80: 25 min · 95: 20 min	~16 min 95 carries service (80: 90 min)
Roughly maintained	Roughly maintained	▲ Improvement	▲ Improvement
Saturday	Sunday		
avg 27 min	avg 37 min		
~14 min 80: 50 min · 95: 20 min	~14 min 80: 50 min · 95: 20 min		
▲ Improvement	▲ Improvement		

The Route 95 upgrade (from ~hourly weekends to 20-min all day, 7 days a week) is the primary driver of improvement on this corridor. The Route 80 extension to Burlington replaces Route 350 but does not materially change frequency here. Note that some current combined trips are very closely spaced due to uncoordinated scheduling; the average is more meaningful than the minimum.

Impact of Proposal 2 Options on this corridor:

OPTION A	No change to Medford corridor frequencies. Route 80 is extended to Arlington Heights, improving access for Arlington commuters traveling toward Davis and Somerville. However, Routes 67 and 350 maintain their existing routing under Option A, meaning Burlington riders do not receive the Route 80 consolidation they would get under the base BNR plan.
OPTION B	Route 94 retained , adding ~34-min-avg trips on the High St / Boston Ave segment between West Medford and Davis. Combined peak frequency would improve to approximately 10–12 min on the shared portion of this corridor.
OPTION C	No change to this corridor specifically. Route 94 still eliminated. Route 95 upgraded as above.

Corridor 2 — Boston Ave between High Street and College Avenue

Current routes: 80 94 96
Proposed (base): 80

SERVICE PERIOD	CURRENT COMBINED (RTS. 80 + 94 + 96)	PROPOSED BNR BASE (RT. 80 ONLY)	CHANGE
Weekday AM peak (5–9 AM)	Weekday midday (9 AM–3 PM)	Weekday PM peak (3–7 PM)	Weekday evening
avg 12 min	avg 15 min	avg 15 min	avg 14 min
25 min	50 min	25 min	90 min
▼ Significant loss	▼ Major loss	▼ Significant loss	▼ Severe loss
Saturday	Sunday		
avg 15 min	avg 17 min		
50 min	50 min		
▼ Major loss	▼ Major loss		

⚠️ **LARGEST SERVICE REDUCTION IN THE BNR FOR MEDFORD**

Boston Ave between High St and College Ave currently has some of the best combined bus frequency in Medford — averaging 11–15 min across all periods, including weekends. Under the base BNR plan (without Option B or C), this corridor drops to a single route (Route 80) running every 25 min peak and 50–90 min off-peak. This is a net reduction of roughly 2–5× depending on time of day.

Impact of Proposal 2 Options on this corridor:

OPTION A	No change to Boston Ave frequency. Route 80 extended to Arlington Heights but same headways. Boston Ave remains at 25/50/90 min depending on period.
OPTION B	Route 94 retained on the Boston Ave corridor. Restores ~34-min-avg trips. Combined peak frequency would recover to approximately 14–17 min — still below the current 12–15 min, but substantially better than the base BNR.
OPTION C	Route 96 rerouted to Boston Ave at 15-min all-day frequency. Combined with Route 80 (25 min peak / 50 min midday): approximately 9 min peak • 12 min midday • 13 min evening . This would be a significant improvement over the base BNR and broadly comparable to current service — but at the cost of George St service (see Corridor 3).

Corridor 3 — George Street between Winthrop Street and College Avenue

Current routes: **96**
Proposed (base): **T96**

SERVICE PERIOD	CURRENT (ROUTE 96)	PROPOSED BNR BASE (T96 — SIMILAR ALIGNMENT)	CHANGE
Weekday AM peak (5–9 AM)	Weekday midday (9 AM–4 PM)	Weekday PM peak (4–7 PM)	Weekday evening (7–10 PM)
avg 27 min	avg 29 min	avg 26 min	avg 30 min
8 min	11 min	8 min	11 min
▲▲ Major upgrade	▲▲ Major upgrade	▲▲ Major upgrade	▲▲ Major upgrade
Saturday	Sunday		
avg 29 min	avg 29 min		
12 min	12 min		
▲▲ Major upgrade	▲▲ Major upgrade		

T96 runs a similar but not identical alignment to the current Route 96 — via Winthrop St, George St, and College Ave toward Medford Square, but extending to Malden Center (north) and Union Square (south) rather than terminating at Harvard. This represents the most dramatic frequency improvement in the BNR for Medford, cutting wait times by roughly two-thirds at peak.

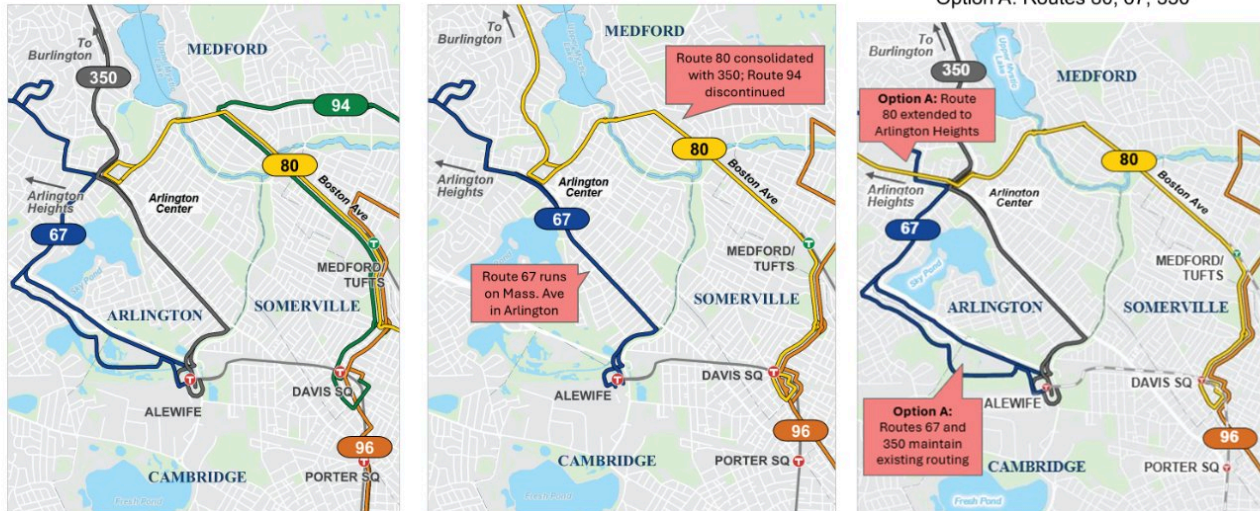
Impact of Proposal 2 Options on this corridor:

OPTION A	No change. T96 implemented as planned on the George St alignment. George St residents receive the full upgrade to 8–12 min service.
OPTION B	No change. T96 implemented as planned on the George St alignment. George St residents receive the full upgrade to 8–12 min service.
OPTION C	Route 96 rerouted off George St entirely. T96 is not implemented. George St and Winthrop St lose all direct bus service. The nearest alternative is the College Ave corridor approximately ¼ mile away. Note: Option C's Boston Ave service (15 min) is also less frequent than the T96 it replaces (8–12 min).

The maps below are reproduced from the MBTA's Proposal 2: Improve Medford Access presentation. Each shows three panels: the existing network (left), the future BNR network without amendments (center), and the amended future network under that option (right). The MBTA is exploring all three options and has not committed to any of them.

OPTION A Route 80 extended to Arlington Heights · Routes 67 and 350 maintain existing routing · Route 94 discontinued

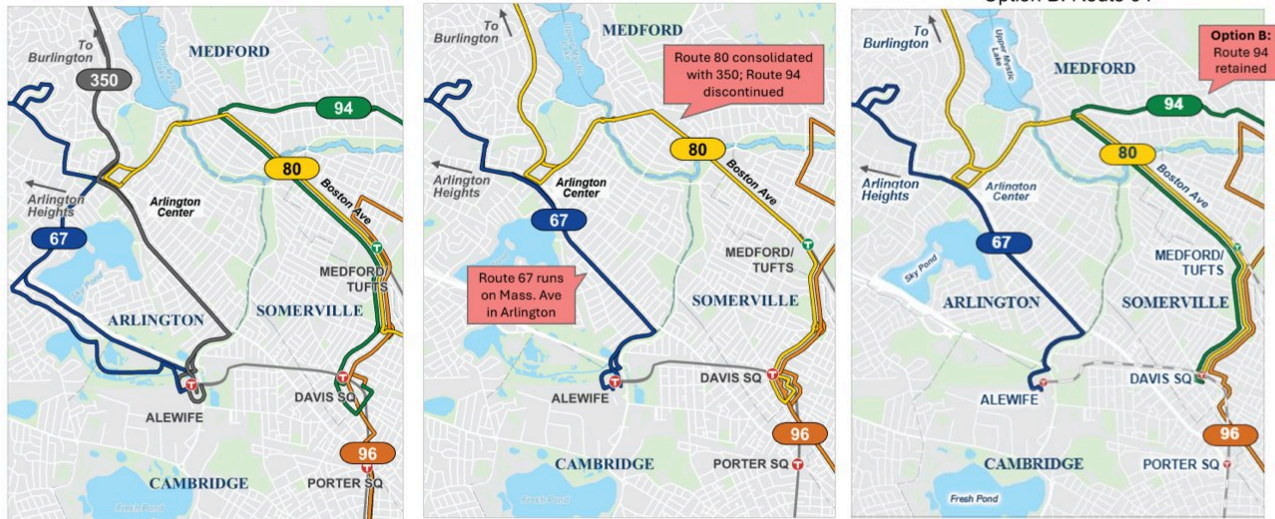
2 Medford: Improving Boston Ave Service: Option A



Option A: The existing network, future network, and amended future network.

OPTION B Route 94 retained on existing alignment · Route 80 consolidated with 350 as planned

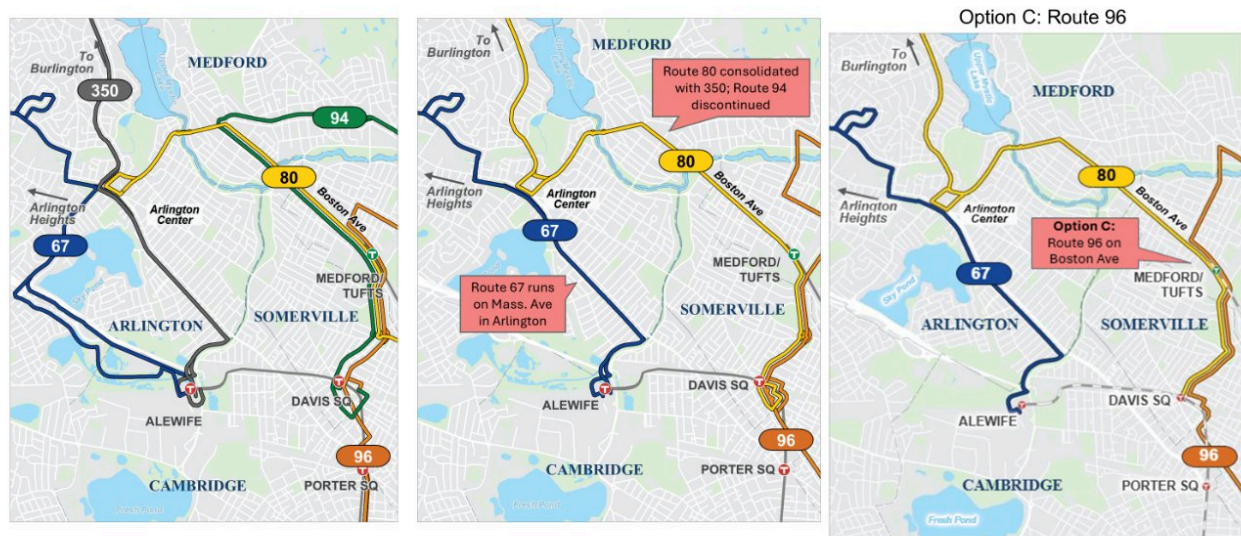
2 Medford: Improving Boston Ave Service: Option B



Option B: The existing network, future network, and amended future network.

OPTION C Route 96 rerouted to Boston Ave • Route 94 discontinued • George St loses direct bus service

2 Medford: Improving Boston Ave Service: Option C



Option C: The existing network, future network, and amended future network.

PART 3 – INDIVIDUAL ROUTE FREQUENCY REFERENCE

Current service from official timetables (eff. April 5, 2026) ·
Proposed from BNR Remix map

[illegible]

SUMMARY OF TRADEOFFS

Option A (extend Rt. 80 to Arlington Heights): No meaningful change to Medford corridor frequencies. T96 upgrade proceeds on George St; Boston Ave drops significantly from current combined service. Benefits Arlington commuters traveling toward Davis and Somerville, but Routes 67 and 350 maintain existing routing, so Burlington riders do not receive the Route 80 consolidation planned under the base BNR. **Option B** (retain Rt. 94): Partially restores Boston Ave combined frequency. George St receives the full T96 upgrade. The most balanced outcome for Medford riders across all three corridors. **Option C** (reroute Rt. 96 to Boston Ave): Significantly improves Boston Ave but eliminates all direct service on George St. Delivers less frequent service on both corridors than the base BNR plan (T96 on George St + improved Route 80 on Boston Ave).

PART 4 — HOW TO PARTICIPATE

Virtual public meeting	June 15, 2026 · 6:00 PM · Register: mbta.com/events/2026-06-15/bus-network-redesign-proposed-updates-virtual
Open houses & station popups	Additional events to be announced for summer 2026. No Medford-specific in-person event has been announced as of June 2026.
Online survey	Available mid-June 2026 · mbta.com/projects/bus-network-redesign-proposed-updates
Email	betterbusproject@mbta.com

Prepared for a Medford City Council resolution, June 2026. Current frequency figures computed from official MBTA timetables for Routes 94, 95, 96, and 80, all effective April 5, 2026. Proposed frequencies from the MBTA Bus Network Redesign Remix planning map (platform.remix.com/project/1ca70dda). BNR routing and service changes from the MBTA BNR Route Changes Summary (February 2023) and MBTA Bus Network Redesign Proposed Updates (June 3, 2026). Combined corridor frequencies reflect merged departure times across all routes serving a segment; actual rider experience may vary due to uncoordinated scheduling. This is not an official MBTA publication. MBTA route maps reproduced from the MBTA's Proposal 2: Improve Medford Access presentation materials.